Lesson
第15課

十二生肖
The Chinese Animal Zodiac

對話— Dialogue 1

15-1-1

宜文：我們下個星期要學第十五課，我剛才先看了一點兒，書上有很多種動物，我覺得很有意思。

友美：有哪些動物？

宜文：我記得有羊、馬、兔子……，最特別的是龍。（打開課本）妳看看……

友美：原來是十二生肖，真的很有意思。

宜文：什麼是十二生肖？

友美：華人用不一樣的動物代表每一年，一共有十二種動物。

國安：越南也有十二生肖，可是我們沒有兔年，有貓年。我是貓年出生的，屬貓。

宜文：真的啊？好有趣！

友美：原來越南的生肖跟中國的有點兒不一樣。

宜文：我好想知道我屬什麼。

國安：很簡單，上網一查就知道了。

宜文：好，我上網查查看。



Text in Simplified Characters

宜文：我们下个星期要学第十五课，我刚才先看了一点儿，书上有很多种动物，我觉得很有意思。

友美：有哪些动物？

宜文：我记得有羊、马、兔子……，最特别的是龙。（打开课本）妳看看……

友美：原来是十二生肖，真的很有意思。

宜文：什么是十二生肖？

友美：华人用不一样的动物代表每一年，一共有十二种动物。

国安：越南也有十二生肖，可是我们没有兔年，有猫年。我是猫年出生的，属猫。

宜文：真的啊？好有趣！

友美：原来越南的生肖跟中国的有点儿不一样。

宜文：我好想知道我属什么。

国安：很简单，上网一查就知道了。

宜文：好，我上网查查看。

Text in Pinyin

Yíwén : Wǒmen xià ge xīngqí yào xué dì shíwǔ kè, wǒ gāngcái xiān kàn le yìdiǎnr, shū shàng yǒu hěn duō zhǒng dòngwù, wǒ juéde hěn yǒuyìsi.

Yǒuměi : Yǒu nǎxiē dòngwù?

Yíwén : Wǒ jìdé yǒu yáng, mǎ, tùzi..., zuì tèbié de shì lóng. (dǎkāi kèběn) Nǐ kànkàn...

Yǒuměi : Yuánlái shì shíèr shēngxiào, zhēnde hěn yǒuyìsi.

Yíwén : Shénme shì shíèr shēngxiào?

Yǒuměi : Huárén yòng bù yíyàng de dòngwù dàibiǎo měi yì nián, yígòng yǒu shíèr zhǒng dòngwù.

Guó'ān : Yuènán yě yǒu shíèr shēngxiào, kěshì wǒmen méi yǒu tù nián, yǒu māo nián. Wǒ shì māo nián chūshēng de, shǔ māo.

Yíwén : Zhēnde ā? Hǎo yǒuqù!

Yǒuměi : Yuánlái Yuènán de shēngxiào gēn Zhōngguó de yǒudiǎnr bù yíyàng.

Yíwén : Wǒ hǎo xiǎng zhīdào wǒ shǔ shénme.

Guó'ān : Hěn jiǎndān, shàngwǎng yì chá jiù zhīdào le.

Yíwén : Hǎo, wǒ shàngwǎng cháchá kàn.

Text in English

Yiwen : We are going to learn lesson fifteen next week. I previewed a bit earlier just now. There are many kinds of animals in the book; I think it is very interesting.

Youmei : What animals are there in the book?

Yiwen : I remember there are goats, horses, rabbits..., and the most special one is the dragon. (open the textbook) You see...

Youmei : Oh! You are talking about the Chinese animal zodiac! It's really interesting.

Yiwen : What is the Chinese animal zodiac?

Youmei : Chinese use different animals to represent each year, and there are a total of twelve kinds of animals.

Guoan : There are also zodiac signs in Vietnam, but we don't have the year of the Rabbit; we have the year of the Cat. I was born in the year of the Cat, which means my zodiac animal sign is cat.

Yiwen : Really? So interesting!

Youmei ：It turns out that the Vietnamese zodiac animals are a little bit different from the Chinese ones.

Yiwen ：I really want to know what my Chinese zodiac animal sign is.

Guoan ：It's very simple. You can know it as soon as you check it online.

Yiwen ：OK, I will do that.

生詞 Vocabulary

15-1-2

1	生肖	shēngxiào	N	The Chinese animal zodiac (12 animals as sings of the Chinese horoscope)
2	課	kè	M	measure word for lessons

我們今天要學第十五課，老師會給我們介紹十二生肖。
We are going to learn lesson fifteen today; our teacher will introduce the Chinese animal zodiac for us.

3	剛才	gāngcái	Adv	just now; a moment ago
4	動物	dòngwù	N	animal

她很喜歡小動物，想要有一隻小狗。
She likes small animals and wants to have a puppy.

5	打開	dǎkāi	Vpt	to open; to turn on
6	課本	kèběn	N	textbook

同學們，現在請打開課本，我們看第十五課。
Students, please open the textbook now. Let's see lesson fifteen.

課文	kèwén	N	text (of a text book)

這課的課文很有意思，我很喜歡。
The text of this lesson is very interesting. I like it very much.

7	原來	yuánlái	Adv	(indicating discovery of the truth) it turns out that...

A：對不起，我不小心拿了你的書。
B：原來書在你這裡，我剛才在教室裡找了好久。
A：I am sorry that I accidentally took your book.
B：It turned out that my book was here with you. I was looking for it in the classroom for a long time just now.

8 華人 Huárén N ethnic Chinese; person of Chinese ethnicity

9 一樣 yíyàng Vs the same

華人和日本人都有十二生肖，十二生肖的動物也一樣嗎？
Chinese and Japanese each have an animal zodiac. Are the animals the same as well?

10 代表 dàibiǎo V to represent

華人用十二生肖代表每一年。
Chinese use twelve zodiac animals to represent each year.

他常常代表學校去參加游泳比賽，所以在學校非常有名。
He often participates in swimming competitions representing the school, so he is very famous at school.

11 越南 Yuènán N Vietnam

12 出生 chūshēng Vp to be born

我是2005年七月在越南出生的。
I was born in Vietnam in July of 2005.

13 屬 shǔ Vst to belong to (the Chinese zodiac signs of, etc)

1997年出生的人屬什麼生肖？
What Chinese zodiac animal sign do people born in 1997 belong to?

14 啊 ā Ptc interrogative final particle (used when the answer is assumed)

A：中明，請問學校圖書館幾點關？
B：你不知道啊？圖書館晚上九點關。
A：Zhongming, excuse me. What time does the school library close?
B：Don't you know? The library closes at nine o'clock in the evening.

15 簡單 jiǎndān Vs simple

大家都覺得做這個菜不難，很簡單。
Everyone thinks that making this dish is not difficult; it's very simple.

16 查 chá V to check; to look up (for information)

我不知道那個地方怎麼去，所以應該先查查地圖。
I do not know how to go to that place, so I think I should check the map first.

Animals

1	羊	yáng	goat; sheep (M:隻)
2	馬	mǎ	horse (M:匹 pī)
3	兔/兔子	tù/tùzi	rabbit (M:隻)
4	龍	lóng	dragon (M:條)

語法 Grammar

15-1-3

I. ……跟……(不)一樣 (Vs)

This pattern is used when comparing two or more people, affairs, or things.

A.

N_1	跟	N_2	(不)一樣	(Vs)
① 我的手機	跟	你的手機	一樣。	
My cell phone is the same as yours.				
② 越南的生肖動物	跟	中國的	不一樣嗎？	
Are the Vietnamese zodiac animals different from the Chinese ones?				
③ 弟弟	跟	哥哥	一樣	聰明。
The younger brother is as clever as his elder brother is.				

1. 這種藥跟那種藥一樣嗎？
2. 這件事情跟那件事情一樣重要。
3. 這棟大樓的電梯跟那棟大樓的（電梯）不一樣大。

B.

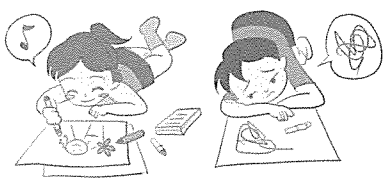
S_1	(VO),	(V得)	跟	S_2	(V得)	(不)一樣Vs
他	(唱歌)	唱得	跟	你		一樣好。
他	(唱歌)		跟	你	唱得	一樣好。
He sings as well as you do.						

1. 他打球，跟哥哥打得一樣好。
2. 姐姐做飯，做得跟媽媽一樣好吃。
3. 那個美國學生寫字，跟中國人寫得一樣好看。

練習 Exercise

Look at the pictures and answer the questions with the pattern "……跟……(不) 一樣 (Vs)".

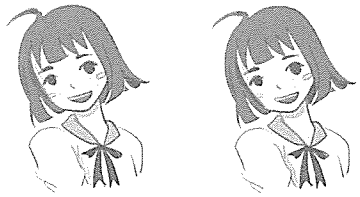
1



A：妹妹的興趣跟弟弟的（興趣）一樣嗎？

B：_____

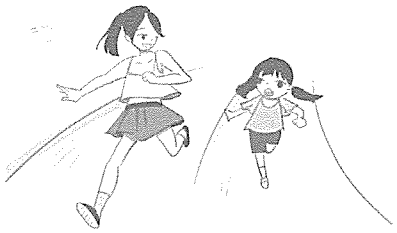
2



A：她今天的心情怎麼樣？

B：_____

3



A：姐姐跑得快，還是妹妹跑得快？

B：_____

II. 一……，就……

This pattern is used to indicate "just as soon as...". If the subjects of these two clauses are the same, then often one subject is omitted.

S	一	V_1,	S	就	V_2
他	一	有問題，		就	問老師。
Whenever he has a question, he asks the teacher.					
S_1	一	V_1,	S_2	就	V_2
你	一	說，	我	就	懂了。
As soon as you said it, I understood it.					

1. 我一看書，就想睡覺。
2. 媽媽一知道我發燒了，就開始擔心。
3. 他今天很奇怪，我一說話，他就不高興。

練習 Exercise

Use the pattern "一……，就……" to rewrite the sentences.

1 你到家以後，馬上給我打電話。

→ _____

2 他說話的時候，大家馬上知道他不是台灣人。

→ _____

3 這件事我決定了以後，馬上開始做了。

→ _____

對話二 Dialogue 2

15-2-1

宜文：中明，你手裡拿著什麼？

中明：這是燈籠。

宜文：燈籠上的小老虎好可愛。

中明：這是我朋友做的，因為他屬虎。妳知道十二生肖嗎？

宜文：知道，友美跟我講過。

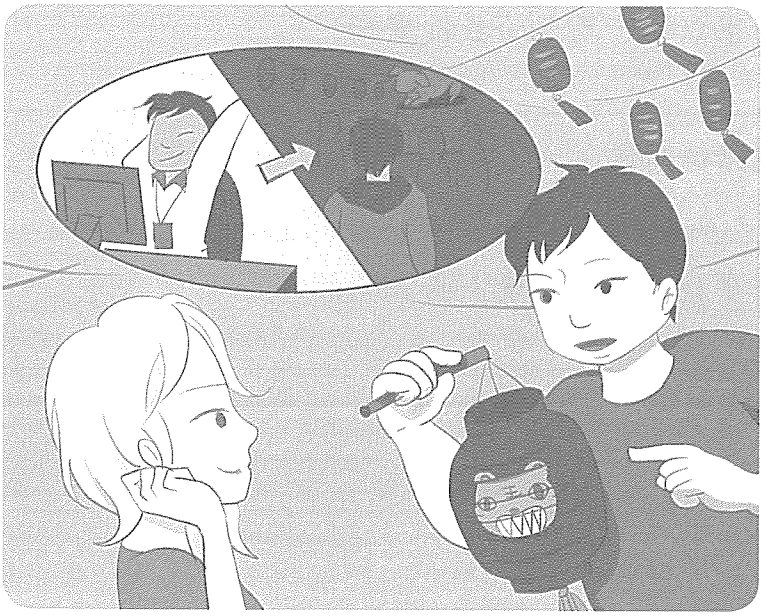
中明：這個星期六是元宵節，妳跟友美會去看燈會嗎？

宜文：友美說她想去，我還沒決定去不去。燈會好玩嗎？

中明：我去年去看了，很多大人帶著小孩去看燈會，非常熱鬧，我照了很多相片。

宜文：那我這個週末一定要去看看。

中明：我週末還要工作，打算一下班就去看燈會。我們可以約友美一起去。



Text in Simplified Characters

宜文：中明，你手里拿着什么？
中明：这是灯笼。
宜文：灯笼上的小老虎好可爱。
中明：这是我朋友做的，因为他属虎。妳知道十二生肖吗？
宜文：知道，友美跟我讲过。
中明：这个星期六是元宵节，妳跟友美会去看灯会吗？
宜文：友美说她想去，我还没决定去不去。灯会好玩吗？
中明：我去年去看了，很多大人带着小孩去看灯会，非常热闹，我照了很多相片。
宜文：那我这个周末一定要去看看。
中明：我周末还要工作，打算一下班就去看灯会。我们可以约友美一起去。

Text in Pinyin

Yíwén ：Zhōngmíng, nǐ shǒu lǐ ná zhe shénme?
Zhōngmíng：Zhè shì dēnglóng.
Yíwén ：Dēnglóng shàng de xiǎo lǎohǔ hǎo kěài.
Zhōngmíng：Zhè shì wǒ péngyǒu zuò de, yīnwèi tā shǔ hǔ. Nǐ zhīdào shíèr shēngxiào ma?
Yíwén ：Zhīdào, Yǒuměi gēn wǒ jiǎng guò.
Zhōngmíng：Zhè ge xīngqí liù shì Yuánxiāojié, nǐ gēn Yǒuměi huì qù kàn dēnghuì ma?
Yíwén ：Yǒuměi shuō tā xiǎng qù, wǒ háiméi juédìng qù bú qù. Dēnghuì hǎowán ma?
Zhōngmíng：Wǒ qùnián qù kàn le, hěn duō dàrén dài zhe xiǎohái qù kàn dēnghuì, fēicháng rènào, wǒ zhào le hěn duō xiàngpiàn.
Yíwén ：Nà wǒ zhè ge zhōumò yídìng yào qù kànkàn.
Zhōngmíng：Wǒ zhōumò hái yào gōngzuò, dǎsuàn yí xiàbān jiù qù kàn dēnghuì. Wǒmen kěyǐ yuē Yǒuměi yìqǐ qù.

Text in English

Yiwen ：Zhongming, what you are holding in your hand?
Zhongming：This is a lantern.

Yiwen : The little tiger on the lantern is so lovely.

Zhongming : This is the lantern that my friend made because his Chinese zodiac animal sign is tiger. Do you know the Chinese animal zodiac?

Yiwen : Yes, Youmei told me already.

Zhongming : This Saturday is the Lantern Festival. Will you and Youmei go to see the Lantern Carnival?

Yiwen : Youmei wants to see it. But I haven't decided to go. Is the Lantern Carnival fun?

Zhongming : Last year I went to see the Carnival. Many adults brought their children to see the Lantern Carnival, and it was very lively. I took a lot of photos.

Yiwen : Well then, I must see it this weekend.

Zhongming : I have to work on weekends, and plan to go to the Lantern Carnival as soon as I get off from work. We can ask Youmei out for the Lantern Carnival together.

生詞 Vocabulary

15-2-2

1 著 zhe Ptc particle indicating progression or continuation of action

他手裡拿著禮物，在學校門口等著女朋友。
He is holding a gift in his hand, and waiting for his girlfriend at the school gate.

2 燈籠 dēnglóng N lantern

3 講 jiǎng V to talk; to explain to someone

明天我要跟朋友去參加跨年活動，我還沒跟父母講這件事。
Tomorrow I will go to join the New Year's Eve celebration with my friends, and I have not told my parents about it yet.

講話 jiǎnghuà V-sep to talk

他在跟家人談事情，已經講了三十分鐘的話了。
He is talking about something with his family, and has already been talking for thirty minutes.

4 好玩 hǎowán Vs interesting; fun

我記得去年跟幾個朋友一起打過籃球，真好玩。
I remember that I played basketball with several friends last year and it was really fun.

5	大人	dàrén	N	adult
6	小孩	xiǎohái	N	child; children

最近感冒的人很多，大人、小孩都應該多注意身體。
Recently lots of people caught a cold. Adults and children both should pay more attention to take care of health.

Names

1	元宵節	Yuánxiāojié	the Lantern Festival (falls on the 15th day of the 1st lunar month)
2	燈會	dēnghuì	Lantern Carnival (a celebration for the New Year and the Lantern Festival)

元宵節燈會是華人新年的重要活動。
The Lantern Carnival of the Lantern Festival is an important event of Chinese New Year.

Animals

1	虎/老虎	hǔ/lǎohǔ	tiger (M: 隻)

語法 Grammar

15-2-3

I. V 著

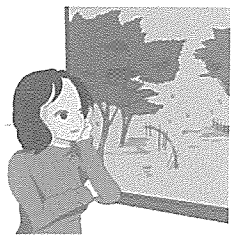
The particle 著 is placed directly after a verb to indicate the continuation of an action or a state.

(1) "V 著" indicates the continuation of an action.

A.

S	V	著	O
她	看	著	窗戶外面的風景。

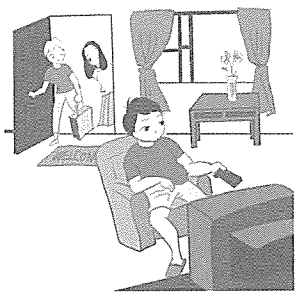
She is looking at the scenery outside the window.

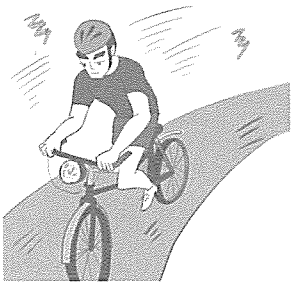


1. 他看著窗戶外面，想著他的女朋友。
2. 他在門口等著你，你快去找他吧。
3. 很多人在那裡唱著歌、跳著舞，大家都很開心。

練習 Exercise

Fill in the blanks using "V 著+O".

1 

2 

3 

1 中明_____，不知道我們已經來了。

2 國安常常_____，到很多地方去玩。

3 宜文_____，_____，覺得很舒服，還不想寫功課。

B. "V 著" indicates a request to maintain a certain action.

S	V	著	(O)	
你們	看	著	我，	不要看書。

Everyone, look at me; do not read your book.

1. 大家聽著，明天一定要準時到。
2. 你看著我，剛才你說的是真的嗎？
3. 你在這裡等著，他們馬上就來了。